



2022

PORTFOLIO
ABSTRACT

Version Control

Version	Changes	Date
Version 1	First Draft	October 9
Version 2	• Slight changes. • Made a git wiki and moved some files over to it.	November 13 2022
Version 3	• Complete change to the design • Added a lot more details in the Git Wiki starting to build up all the necessary information. • Moved my portfolio abstract from Canva to Google Docs to make it seem more professional.	December 18 2022
Version 4	• Created Git Wiki made it easier to use and more readable. • Improved sections and added more to each of the sections and added more depth to the Discovery, Define, Develop & Deliver Phases. • Added more details about my interviews and my group's survey.	January 19 2023
Version 5	• Updated burden of proof • Added the "Passion Project" section • Added the Reflection • Added final Presentation • Cleaned up Git Massively • Added Final User Testing • Added Product Description • Fixed Dates on Home Page • Added more about use of discord to communicate • Added More about our prototype to product process • Added additional items to my concept section & my interactive media section • Updated the connections to Git Wiki • Improved layout and order of assignments	January 22 2023

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Introduction



My name is Connor McClanahan and I am a Media & Design student in his third semester at Fontys University of applied sciences. I am interested in UXD and mobile development and wish to grow my skills this semester in all aspects of being a designer. We are working on three classes this semester: Influencer, Hacker, and Designer. These classes are designed to teach us to bring an idea into reality.

My Personal Goals

I look forward to advancing my programming capabilities and understanding this semester. I am most interested in Front End development and full stack. To me, this is the most interesting because once you start connecting a bunch of different software together you get a much more complete and working product in the end.

Client Project Assignment

Introduction

My group for the project is called UnXpectica, our approach this semester has been to follow the double diamond approach, and first, we started off in the discovery phase where we explored what is available on the market, the Digital Substitution case that we chose. We found out that there might be a need for an online high school teacher or an online pet recommendation website. Therefore, we narrowed down our scope to two ideas. After this, we continued and decided on delving deeper into the idea of a pet recommendation website. After this, we moved on to the define phase where we did user research to define the problem and think of ways to make it a digital solution. Finally, now we are just getting into the developmental stage where we begin to make basic designs and mockups for our product.

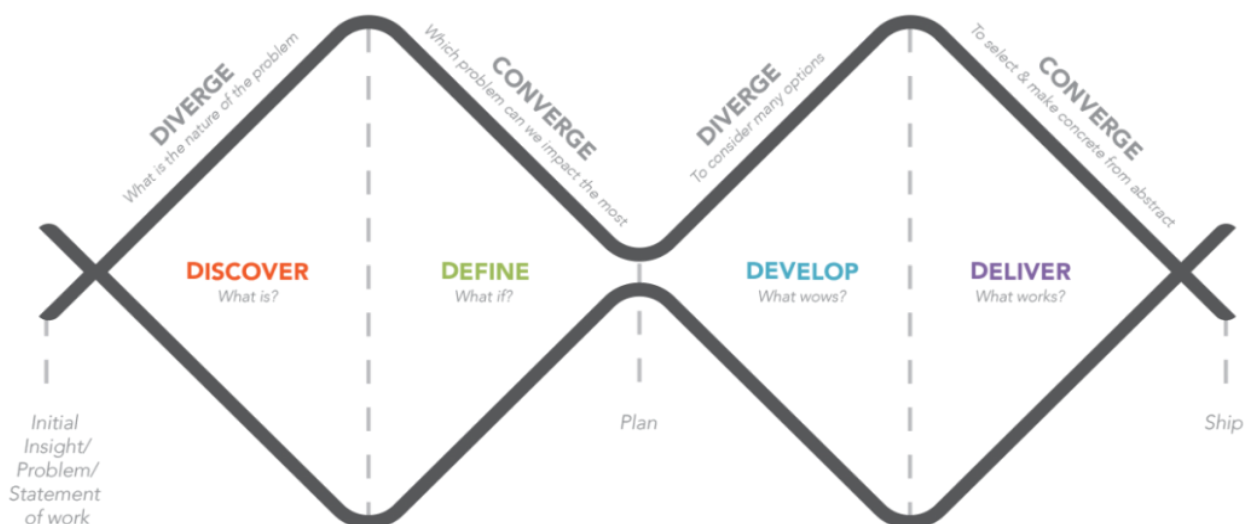
Plan of action

First, we set up our [\[Blog\]](#) in order to make sure people can easily see what we have made with a short explanation. We also have our own discord and WhatsApp groups for us to share files and communicate on a day-to-day basis. We also made a [\[Git\]](#) to organize files and for our group to have a place to put files once they were complete. After our group was shown the double diamond we felt it would benefit our organization and design process. We kept people up to date and accountable using primarily discord because it is an all-in-one platform where we can easily call and text and upload files, but after they were posted there they were swiftly moved on to Git. Additionally, we also met every week on Thursday to discuss the progress of our product and to keep everyone accountable.

Double Diamond

After talking with our teachers and being taught how to use it we decided to use the double diamond method to build our app. This method has 4 different phases which we will work through in 4 different sprints. The first phase is the **discovery phase**. In this phase, go into broad research in different ways to gain knowledge about problems people have with finding pets. The second phase is the **define phase**. In this phase, we will take a look at the results of our research. Depending on what we found, we will think of different ideas and solutions that might assist in finding people better animals for their lifestyle. This phase is the **development phase** where we take our ideas and turn them into prototypes. We run user tests to determine if our product is working as intended. In the fourth and final phase, the **delivery phase** we will deliver a fully working prototype.

Design Thinking 'Double Diamond' Process Model



Approach and Results

Discovery Phase

To figure out the direction we wanted to go in after choosing our “Digital Solution” case we began by making this [Online Reaserch](#) document here we decided on our plan to do a pet website. I assisted in this by giving some other competition websites like Kahn Academy which is a teaching website for students in America. We were looking for inspiration or different ideas to add to our website. During this time we began discussing the possibility of adding a tips section to our page to leverage the existing people and keep retention high. We gained this insight from the online research we did, without which I doubt we would have thought of adding this section to our website.

To begin our research we started off doing a basic survey about pets to assist in the decision to pursue a pet recommendation website. This was an acceptable survey for the time when we first made it but later down the line, we had to create an updated more refined survey. My group then analyzed the information from our survey in our [\[Way of Working\]](#) document that focused on our ideas and made a plan to do research on our different ideas to make a decision for the best course of action for our group. Even if this is an informal blog this is where we

outlined the basic feedback that we got during our introductory survey, and our plans going into the future.

After gaining some feedback about how we should improve our survey we updated and created a [\[survey\]](#) to gain a more accurate insight into our target audience now that we have a more solid plan. It was then outlined in our survey analysis where we connected the two surveys and made a more complete outline. This is also where we decided to move on towards gaining more in more information about pets and how the pet industry operates.

To find more detailed information about the usage of our idea and the importance of it giving people accurate information about pets. First, we made a [\[interview plan\]](#) to give us a structure to follow to get the most important information from our Experts. Next, I and another group member made [\[expert interviews\]](#) with a veterinarian and a pet shop owner. This helped us to decide on our plan to make a pet website to reduce animals in shelters and not limit ourselves to just one type of animal. We also discussed and found some issues with how we were going to operate, once talking to our two experts one of the experts a pet shop owner, explained that most people who came in to get a pet usually had a pet in mind, we did some follow up research by asking people, and found that most people who are interested already have an animal in mind and don't need to be

told what type of animal they need they just want to know more about the breeds. This made us slightly shift gears to where now we were focusing on multiple separate surveys making our algorithm a bit more simple and also appealing to our target audience.

To analyze the data we got from the interviews and survey, I and another group member made a [\[affinity map\]](#) that helped us conclude that our decision to make a pet recommendation website is beneficial to people and has a good chance to reduce the number of animals in shelters. This affinity map was built for use in displaying what we understood from the expert interviews, here it concludes that the idea we are pursuing is beneficial and could be used by people in the industry. Additionally, it also explains that each breed is drastically different and can be great to organize and help people find the most ideal one for them.

Define Phase

To gain insight into how the brain of someone interested in pets thinks, I did a target audience [\[interview\]](#) with a person within our target audience of people who are interested in pets. My user has pets and is looking at the possibility of finding more pets. This helped our group have a more accurate view of what the users want in a pet recommendation website. These interviews conducted by my group helped us to collect our thoughts and the thoughts of our users.

Based on both our survey and the interviews we conducted, we made an [\[empathy map\]](#) to visualize better what people's opinions on having a pet are and how it's perceived. I helped out with making this empathy map and primarily used the information from my interviews to build it. It covers the emotions that a potential user would have while looking for a pet, we are looking for ways to make it easier and better for both the user and the pet.

To gain insight and a target audience we created accurately [\[personas\]](#) This gave us a better understanding regarding who we are creating our product for. Now we have characters we can think of when developing our concept. This helps me in creating the best possible product.

To have a deeper understanding of our target's wants and needs, I created a [\[POV and HMW\]](#) for our target. This helps me create an easy understanding of purpose and direction for our group to develop further.

To advance our ideas for our advice section, I made this [\[secondary research\]](#) document to go along with my group's [\[website content research\]](#) here is where we just developed exactly what we wanted in the side of the advice and questions sections of our product. Overall it was a good experience and allowed us to come up with the idea to create a rating system to make sure all of our advice is beneficial to our users.

Finally, we created [\[design challenge\]](#) which helped us to get a general idea of what we want to develop for our users. This allows us as a group to know what to work on and what our next step should be. With this, we finalized a portion of our research and moved on to the next phase.

Develop Phase

At the beginning of the new phase we had a great opportunity to work with our stakeholders at Livewall to make a [\[pitch\]](#) so we could showcase our ideas, and plan for the future. It was pretty rocky but our idea was solid so we took some notes and I planned to present for our final presentation.

Before we began creating prototypes and designing our product we first created the [\[concept document\]](#) here we detailed our plans for developing our product from the concept description to more detailed research and content for our site that we have discovered so far. This was basically the direction we were going in and it described all the necessary information to proceed in creating our product.

To begin developing we began to make prototypes. We started off making a [\[low-fidelity\]](#) prototype with a loose idea of what we intended to make based on our pitch because the feedback we got was that we didn't have enough of a product to show. We used this as a launching point for us to design our survey section, we wanted it to be simple and easy to use and easy for someone of any age group to understand. This allowed us to jump right into designing our website when we entered the development phase.

To accentuate our idea and to see how complicated we were going to make it we created a [\[High fidelity\]](#) prototype. This allowed us to make a clear plan for the future and for us to have a good product identity with a style that we need to follow. This also let us an easy way to get feedback and make changes before coding was necessary I wrote down some of the changes in my [\[Petica UI\]](#) document.

To clean up our design and create a more usable and beautiful design, each member of our group created a video [\[Prototyping\]](#) on our wireframe with the goal of finding usability issues and things that a first-time user can spot. We got a lot of valuable feedback and made changes accordingly. For instance, in a lot of our tests, users mentioned the navigation bar was hard to follow so we structured it and made it more usable and straightforward. This feedback helped me and a few of my group members to talk about it during a class where we got feedback from our teacher and found the most optimal nav bar and the one we are currently using in our product.

Deliver Phase

To visualize and make an accurate suggestion website we have begun coding and I have made a [\[suggestor\]](#) section with a group member. This helps us be on the right track to having enough time to finish up everything we want in this product. Once we started working we divided up the work between everyone so I had to design the suggestion part of our site and make it usable for everyone to put their animals in their section so I tried to make it as modular as possible. Once I began making it I noticed there was no back button so I added that as well. The overall algorithm is created by my group but the designs and the changing questions were created by me.

To present and finalize our product I and my group began the creation of our [\[Final Presentation\]](#) here I and my group created a slideshow to display all of our processes and what features of our product Petica. I believe that overall the whole presentation went well, I presented and I believe that the ad that we played at the beginning was super beneficial in setting the tone for the rest of our presentation. The only negative comment that I felt we got our something that was missing the fact that when someone receives our suggestion there is no way to tell how Petica decided that should be their pet.

Our final document is our [\[Petica Product Description\]](#) here we basically lay it all out all the information about our product our plans for the future, and what we use in it everything is detailed here and easily accessible. The rundown is that there is a lot we want to add and can be added easily in the future and that we think there is seriously a market out there for us to sell our product to, if we communicate with local pet shops and shelters we think there is a market that we can tap into.

Thinking back on this semester I can see just how much I have grown and learned, of all the semesters I think this one is the one where a lot of what I have been learning really clicked and I found what direction I want to go in. I wrote about what I have learned in my [\[Reflection\]](#). Overall though I am stratified with the effort I have put into our product and how my public speaking skills have improved alongside my Java Script programming. In the future, the only thing I would like to do differently would be to jump into making designs and prototypes earlier to give us more time to actually develop a more advanced algorithm.

Passion Project

Introduction

Although this is already a challenge I would still consider it my passion project. The [\[Hacker Special Challenge\]](#) was a great experience for me and taught me a ton about programming and using actual stacks and backend in a website. To begin just using this taught me more about JavaScript than I have learned from anything else. Just having to explore myself has pushed me and taught me that I can learn anything as long as I put my mind to it. From PHP, SCSS, JavaScript, and even frameworks.

Portfolio Features

Getting back to my actual project I made a portfolio website with some loose rules about what I needed to make, so in the end I completed all the tasks but went back to make some fun little small things because I enjoyed it so much and this is why I call thing my passion project. First I made a logo from scratch and made some cool animations with SCSS on my `thankyou.html` page and also made some hover and flip effects with my picture and logo on the home page.

Reflection

Overall making this portfolio website has ignited a love for full-stack development in me and has motivated me to learn more every day about different frameworks and software I can use in the future. I am really excited especially about using Flutter and learning how to create mobile applications.

Burden of Proof

Learning outcome	Self-assessment	Proof
Concept	Proficient	[Concept]
Interaction design	Proficient	[Interaction design]
Interactive media product	Proficient	[Interactive media product]
Transferable code	Advanced	[Transferable code]
Professional iterations	Proficient	[Professional iterations]
Advice to stakeholder	Proficient	[Advice to stakeholder]
Personal professional focus	Advanced	[Personal professional focus]